媽媽，你睡了嗎

Dear mama

POSTPARTUM SANCTUARY PLAN

Postpartum Sanctuary Plan

For you, whether you're preparing for the postpartum period or already in it

Mama, whether you're still pregnant or already in the whirlwind after birth,
this plan was made for you.
If you're still pregnant, it's a map you can fill in slowly.
If your baby has already arrived, you don't need to start at the beginning.
Start with whichever page helps you most.

The weeks after birth can be exhausting, and sometimes you may feel low for no clear reason.
It isn't because you're not strong enough, or because you don't love your baby enough.
It may be hormones, too little sleep, or simply not having enough help around you right now.
This plan helps you map out your escape routes ahead of time.

Write these down now, just in case

If you feel persistently low after birth, or have thoughts of not wanting to live or of being unable to care for yourself or your baby,
please don't carry it alone. Save these two numbers now (Taiwan):

Suicide Prevention Line
1925
24 hours a day

Maternal Care Hotline
0800-870-870
Mon–Fri 9:00–17:00 (closed on public holidays)

Asking for help isn't weakness. It's you taking responsibility for yourself and your baby.

If you're still pregnant, now is the best time to fill this in, so that when the postpartum rush arrives you already have a map to follow. If you're already postpartum, just pick the one or two pages you need most right now. It's fine to leave blanks. This plan will be here waiting for you.

1. Caring for Your Body

Visitors at each stage · Recharging your body · Small things that bring you back

This is _____ 's Postpartum Sanctuary Plan Date _____

✦ Visitors at each stage

Recovery has its own rhythm. Not everyone is right for every stage. It's not about how close you are, but about what I need right now.

Early recovery (still bleeding, body at its most fragile): Who do I want with me? Who should I ask to come later?

Adjusting (a little better, but still very tired): Who would I welcome to lend a hand?

Reconnecting (starting to want company): Who do I want to reconnect with first?

✦ Recharging your body

Decide on your body's basic needs now, instead of at your most exhausted moment.

Sleep: I know what I'm like when I'm sleep-deprived. Who can watch the baby so I can really rest?

Food: What food restores my strength? What do I definitely want to eat, and what do I not want?

Touch: Do I need more hugs, or a massage? Who can I tell, and how can it be arranged?

☐ During this time, I allow myself to simply rest. I don't need to be productive.

✦ Small things that bring you back

When I feel anxious or overwhelmed, a few small things I know can help me feel like myself again.

Small things that quickly restore my energy or bring me calm and joy:

A sunny, breezy spot where I can sit for a while with my baby:

2. Your Support Plan

Your support can be a partner, a postpartum doula, family elders, close friends, or even yourself

If you don't have a ready-made teammate, this is where you start building your own support network.

✦ First, take stock: who is in my circle?

Someone I can share my true feelings with, who won't judge me:

Someone who can hold the baby while I shower:

Someone I feel safe talking to about hard parenting decisions:

Someone I'd like to visit me once a week:

✦ Then agree: how do I want them to support me?

Pick one or two main supporters. Each of you think it over, then swap answers when you can.

My love language (words of affirmation / quality time / acts of service / physical touch / gifts):

What do I look like under stress? How can my supporter and I tell when the other is just pushing through?

When I'm pushing through, how do I want them to help? What's our shared way of carrying the stress together?

✦ Say it out loud: three things I allow myself to say

After birth we often swallow our needs, afraid of being a burden. Practice saying them here, to your supporters, or to yourself first.

I want to be seen for: (what I wish someone knew I'm going through)

I need to be held when: (the moments I most need someone with me)

I want to be trusted with: (the choices and ways I want others to trust)

3. Sharing the Load at Home

What drains us most after birth isn't the chores themselves, but the belief that we should be doing them all

Go through these common postpartum tasks one by one. For each, do you want to **let go**, **hand off**, or **do it yourself**? No writing needed, just tick.

	Let go	Hand off	I'll do it
Dishes and tidying the kitchen	☐	☐	☐
Cooking meals / heating confinement meals	☐	☐	☐
Washing, drying and folding laundry	☐	☐	☐
Mopping, vacuuming, wiping surfaces	☐	☐	☐
Taking out rubbish, running errands	☐	☐	☐
Preparing baby's food	☐	☐	☐
Bathing the baby	☐	☐	☐
Night feeds and settling to sleep	☐	☐	☐
Replying to messages, arranging visitors	☐	☐	☐
School runs and time with older children	☐	☐	☐

How many did you tick under "I'll do it"? That column is often not what others expect of you, but what you expect of yourself. Just noticing it is already a first step.

Ideas A postpartum doula, hourly cleaners, laundry services, family taking shifts: all great ways to hand things off. Think of paying for rest as an investment in your recovery.

4. If you have someone by your side, invite them to this page

Seen · Held · Trusted: this time, we plan together

This page is optional. If you don't have that person right now, skip it. Everything before it is still fully yours.

✦ Think on your own first, then compare answers

One line each. Say it out loud, or write it down and swap.

Seen: What I most need you to see is _____; I guess what you most need me to see is _____

Held: When I most need you to catch me is _____; what I can catch for you is _____

Trusted: What I hope you trust me with is _____; what I trust you with is _____

✦ Three things couples often fight about after birth: let's agree now

Not to argue, but to agree before we're too exhausted to think straight.

Nights: Who looks after the baby at night? How do we take turns? (Sleep deprivation is the number one cause of postpartum conflict.)

Visitors and family: Who may visit? How long can they stay? Who holds the boundaries, and how?

When I fall apart: If I break down, what do I want you to do? What would make it worse?

✦ Our secret signal

When one of us is about to crack, we say a phrase only we understand, and the other knows: it's my turn to take over, no questions asked.

Our signal is _____

DEAR MAMA

Finally, one more thing

You care for your baby. You deserve care too.

This plan isn't about doing things more perfectly.
It's about thinking ahead, so that in your most fragile weeks you can rest, be cared for, and be held, without guilt.

When looking for professional help, search by type of service for the most up-to-date information: postnatal OB-GYN check-ups, lactation support, pelvic floor physiotherapy, mental health clinics or community mental health centres, postpartum doulas and confinement centres. For any physical or emotional warning signs, follow your medical team's advice.

If you or a mother near you has thoughts of self-harm or of being unable to care for the baby, call the helplines on page one right away (Taiwan: 1925 · 0800-870-870), contact your local emergency number, or go to the emergency department.

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